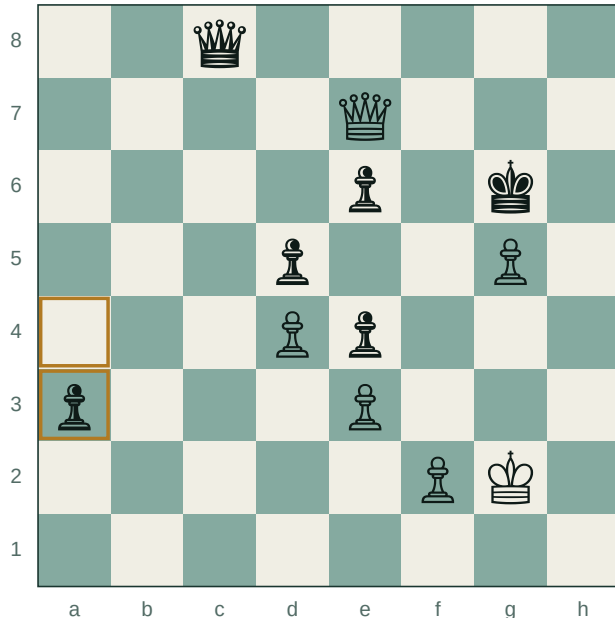


Discovered checks: White, move 53

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 52...a3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

53. Qf6+ Kh7 54. g6+ Kh6 55. g7+ Kh7 56. Qf8

53.Qf6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **53...Kh7**.

54.g6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **54...Kh6**.

55.g7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on f6 attacks the king on h6. Recorded reply: **55...Kh7**.

56.Qf8 The queen moves from f6 to f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +0:** the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: queen on c8. Check for tactical protection.